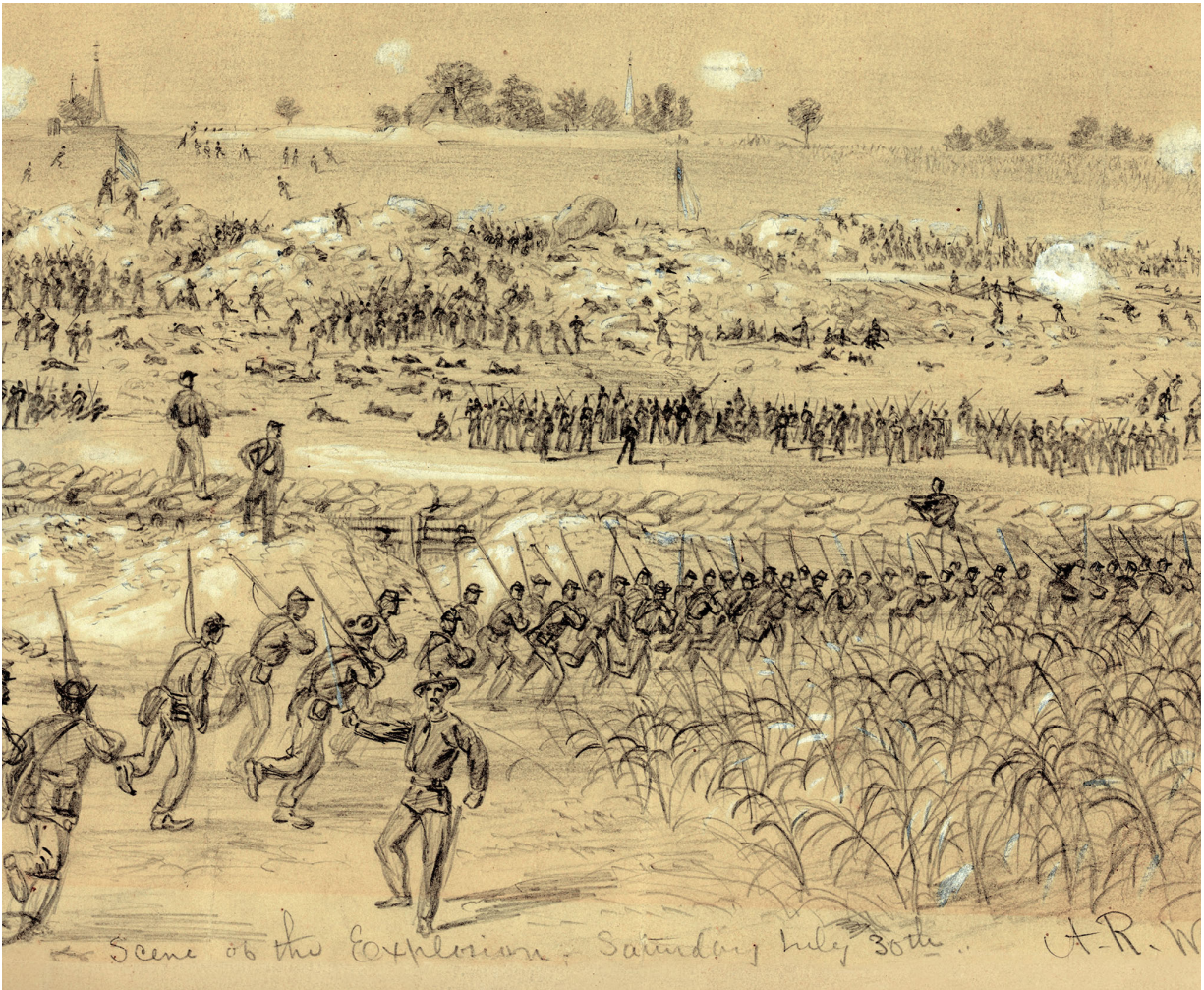


brigade commanders could realize the situation, the two brigades became inextricably mixed ... Up on the other side of the crater they climbed ... In doing so members of these regiments were killed by musket-shots from the rear, fired by the Confederates who were still occupying the traverses and intrenchments to the right and left of the crater ... This coming so unexpectedly caused the forming line to fall back into the crater."

UNION MAJOR WILLIAM H. POWELL, FROM *BATTLES AND LEADERS OF THE CIVIL WAR*, 1888



After the explosion

War artist Alfred R. Waud drew the scene after the mine exploded. In the foreground Union soldiers head from their entrenchments toward the Confederate line, beyond the mounds of earth thrown up by the explosion.